04 · Resource Plan (RACI chart and Resource Allocation Overview): writing guide

Owner suggestion: Member 2. **Length:** 2 to 3 pages. **Time:** 25 to 35 minutes.

Purpose

Show **who did what** (RACI), **what resources the project used** and how the work was shared (allocation). The brief asks for "Resource Plan (RACI Chart, Resource Allocation)".

Key ideas explained simply

RACI chart: a table with activities down the side and people across the top. Each cell holds one letter:

- **R, Responsible:** does the work.
- **A, Accountable:** owns the result and signs it off. **Exactly one A per row.**
- **C, Consulted:** gives input before the work is finished (two-way).
- **I, Informed:** told about progress or results (one-way). A person can be both A and R. Every activity needs at least one R and exactly one A.

Resource allocation: all resources (people, tools, infrastructure, money, time) and how they were used or divided.

Step 1: map the brief's roles to your three people

The brief lists six roles: **Project Manager, Backend Developers, Frontend Developers, QA Engineers, Security Specialist, Community Liaison** (and "other"). You are three people, so each person holds two or more roles. Write this down first, as a table:

Member	Name	Main role	Additional roles
1		*Example:* Project Manager	QA, Community Liaison
2			
3			

Be honest: use the roles people actually played. The contribution page and the video must match.

Step 2: RACI chart

Activities (adapt to your project plan and WBS from Term 2):

Activity	Member 1	Member 2	Member 3
Project charter and planning			
Stakeholder analysis and communication plan			
Requirements and user stories (backlog)			
UI/UX wireframes and design			
Backend: database and API			
Backend: authentication and security			
Frontend: screens and PWA			
Testing and bug tracking			
Risk management and change control			
Sprint planning and retrospectives			
Vendor onboarding and community engagement			
Documentation and final report			
Demo video and presentation			
Deployment and handover			

Under the table, add the legend: R = Responsible, A = Accountable, C = Consulted, I = Informed. **Check before you submit:** exactly one A in every row; nobody is empty in every row; the workload looks balanced.

Step 3: Resource allocation overview

People:

Resource	Role(s)	Tasks	Hours or % per week	Period
Member 1				
Member 2				
Member 3				

Tools and infrastructure (these were really used; keep the ones that apply):

Resource	Type	Used for	Cost
Java 21, Spring Boot 4, Maven	Software (free)	Back end	R0
Vue 3, Vite, Pinia, Vue Router	Software (free)	Front end and installable app	R0
MySQL / MariaDB	Software (free)	Database	R0
Git and GitHub	Software (free)	Version control, collaboration, CI	R0
VS Code, IntelliJ	Software (free)	Development	R0
Blackboard	University system	Submissions, group sign-up	R0
Free-licence stock photos (credits in project)	Content	Demo listings	R0
Laptops and internet	Equipment	Development, demo recording	Your own estimate
Local hosting on a laptop	Infrastructure	Running the demo	R0

Budget: state the total (probably R0 in software, plus your estimate of data and electricity or time cost if you want to show it). If you later host the system, add estimates for hosting and an email service as *future* costs and label them clearly as estimates.

Step 4: short paragraphs (your words)

1. **How the work was divided and why** (strengths, interests, availability).
2. **Resource constraints you faced** (team of three instead of the brief's suggested six roles, limited time, no budget) and how you handled them.
3. **Workload balancing:** did anyone become a bottleneck? What did you change?
4. **Future resource needs** if the project continued (hosting, email, payment gateway fees, support person).

Common mistakes

- More than one A (or no A) in a row.
- A RACI that does not match what really happened or the video.
- Listing six roles but only three people, with no explanation.
- Inventing costs or hours. Use real or clearly labelled estimates.

Checklist

- [ ] Role mapping table for all three members
- [ ] RACI with one A per row and a legend
- [ ] People, tools and budget tables

- [ ] Paragraphs on division of work, constraints, balancing and future needs
- [ ] Matches the contribution page and the stakeholder matrix owners